

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

FOURTH SECTION

CASE OF KUZIN AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 41710/21 and 29 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

14 May 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Kuzin and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Fourth Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

Branko Lubarda*, President*,
Armen Harutyunyan,
Ana Maria Guerra Martins*, judges*,
and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 11 April 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

3. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

4. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies. Some applicants also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

5. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

6. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications (see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

7. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

8. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

9. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014 and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

10. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

11. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

12. Some applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention and its Protocols, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

13. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention and its Protocols in the light of its findings in *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*, no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies; *Karelin v. Russia*, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85, 20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a

prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO); *Elvira Dmitriyeva v. Russia*, nos. 60921/17 and 7202/18, §§ 77-90, 30 April 2019, as to administrative conviction for making calls to participate in public assemblies; *Martynyuk v. Russia*, no. 13764/15, §§ 38-42, 8 October 2019, relating to the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal against the sentence of administrative detention.

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

14. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings in paragraphs 9, 10 and 13 above, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

15. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under the well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention and the Protocols thereto as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*

(a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;

(b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 14 May 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina	Branko Lubarda
Acting Deputy Registrar	President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative / criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
1.	41710/21 03/08/2021	**Yuriy Anatolyevich KUZIN** 1987		Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 4 days	Moscow City Court 04/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 3.45 p.m. 31/01/2021 until 3.45 p.m. on 02/02/2021.	5,000
2.	41725/21 31/07/2021	**Denis Vladimirovich KURUSHIN** 1990	Chashchilova Mariya Valeryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 10 days	Moscow City Court 16/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 1.37 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 10.00 a.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
3.	41740/21 06/08/2021	**Maksim Yevgenyevich DOMOZHIROV** 1993	Kurochko Yelena Viktorovna Vologda	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Vologda 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Vologda Regional Court 27/04/2021		3,500

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4.	41941/21 10/08/2021	**Aleksandr Sergeyevich DMITRIYEV** 1998	Polyakova Veronika Valeryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 10 days	Moscow City Court 10/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000
5.	42050/21 03/08/2021	**Ilya Pavlovich SHAMOVSKIY** 1997	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 05/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
6.	42060/21 03/08/2021	**Konstantin Yuryevich MASLOV** 1994	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 05/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
7.	42091/21 04/08/2021	**Mikhail Aleksandrovich ALIYEV** 1986	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 8 days	Moscow City Court 21/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 4 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 01/02/2021, when the applicant was taken to the Babushkinskiy District Court, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000

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8.	42100/21 04/08/2021	**Yevgeniya Yuryevna MAYOROVA** 1994	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 10 days	Moscow City Court 04/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000
9.	42102/21 04/08/2021	**Marat Rashitovich NAFIKOV** 1986	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 15 days	Moscow City Court 09/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 1.40 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 9.40 p.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000
10.	42106/21 03/08/2021	**Dmitriy Sergeyevich TARASOV** 1988	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 05/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
11.	42108/21 04/08/2021	**Nikita Sergeyevich KARNAUKHOV** 1994	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 05/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000

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12.	42110/21 04/08/2021	**Ivan Anatolyevich LOBACHEV** 1988	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 08/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
13.	42123/21 03/08/2021	**Vladislav Aleksandrovich VETOKHIN** 1997	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 05/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
14.	42151/21 31/07/2021	**Dmitriy Svyatoslavovich MAKAROVSKIY** 1988	Chashchilova Mariya Valeryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 13/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
15.	42400/21 06/08/2021	**Pavel Sergeyevich STRUNIN** 1988	Lepekhin Andrey Gennadyevich Chelyabinsk	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Chelyabinsk 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 2 of CAO	detention for 9 days	Chelyabinsk Regional Court 09/02/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	5,000

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16.	42510/21 05/08/2021	**Sergey Nikolayevich VERBITSKIY** 1983	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 8 days	Moscow City Court 04/02/2021 (decision served on the applicant on the following days)	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000
17.	42579/21 11/08/2021	**Adelina Timeryanovna BATYRSHINA** 2001	Nurgaleyev Danil Ilnurovich Kazan	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 24/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 2 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 4.30 p.m. on 01/02/2021	4,000
18.	42587/21 11/08/2021	**Yelizaveta Sergeyevna YELISEYEVA** 1999	Nurgaleyev Danil Ilnurovich Kazan	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 24/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 2 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 4.30 p.m. on 01/02/2021	4,000
19.	42588/21 11/08/2021	**Valeriya Eduardovna NIKOLAYEVA** 2000	Nurgaleyev Danil Ilnurovich Kazan	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 03/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 2 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 4.30 p.m. on 01/02/2021	4,000

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20.	43237/21 09/08/2021	**Fedor Alekseyevich ZAKHAROV** 2000	Eysmont Mariya Olegovna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 10 days	Moscow City Court 10/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 6.40 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 4.50 p.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
21.	55895/21 29/10/2021	**Vladislav Yuryevich RYBALKO** 1995	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 17/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
22.	55900/21 29/10/2021	**Anton Viktorovich SYASIN** 1990	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 17/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
23.	55912/21 29/10/2021	**Yelena Vitalyevna YELTSOVA** 2000	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 5,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 28/07/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	3,500

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24.	56863/21 15/11/2021	**Tatyana Aleksandrovna POKROVSKAYA** 1970	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 19/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
25.	56916/21 15/11/2021	**Yuriy Ivanovich KUREYEV** 1993	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 05/07/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	3,500
26.	57035/21 10/11/2021	**Sergey Mikhaylovich TERTIYENKO** 1998	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 13/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	3,500
27.	57108/21 07/10/2021	**Yelizaveta Leonidovna ZAGORSKAYA** 1998	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Samara 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Samara Regional Court 08/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

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28.	57171/21 30/10/2021	**Anastasiya Sergeyevna KASYANOVA** 2002	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kurgan 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 8 of CAO	detention for 20 days	Kurgan Regional Court 01/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 8.10 p.m. on 21/04/2021 until 10.13 a.m. on 22/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000
29.	58278/21 18/11/2021	**Aleksey Igorevich KRIVOSHEIN** 1994	Pershakova Yelena Yuryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 19/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
30.	58684/21 15/11/2021	**Mikhail Andreyevich PANFILOV** 1997	Sharangiya Sofya Zurabovna Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 16/06/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	3,500

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.